

Rehan Ali Mirza

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Experience

University of Pennsylvania

Doctoral Researcher, Annenberg School for Communication

Philadelphia, PA

Aug 2025 – Present

- Use computational and mixed methods to study platform design, governance, and online discourse
- Current projects include a community moderation survey experiment; using design-based supervised learning to develop a discourse quality metric; and grounded-theory approaches to platform governance

Prosocial Design Network

Fellow

Remote

Apr 2025 – Apr 2026

- Facilitated expert working group sessions and co-authored report on researcher-practitioner collaboration to catalyze actionable platform-design research
- Led social media section of report mapping 30+ LLM-enabled tools for public discourse, surveying 25+ tool developers

Shorenstein Center, Harvard Kennedy School

Policy Researcher

Cambridge, MA

2023 – 2024

- Analyzed Facebook Papers for platform governance case studies and policy recommendations; developed voter education resources; engaged FCC, FTC, and Obama Foundation

L.E.K. Consulting

Strategy Consultant

London, UK

2017 – 2021

- Delivered quantitative analysis, market research, and strategic recommendations across 20+ commercial and public-sector projects for senior client stakeholders
- Led workstreams involving financial modeling, survey analysis, large dataset analysis, and 60+ stakeholder interviews

Projects

Integrity Institute

Tech Policy Tracker, Operational Lead

Remote

Aug 2024 – Present

- Developed public U.S. federal/state tech-legislation tracker with LLM-assisted summarization, thematic classification, and searchable front-end; built semi-automated Python pipeline using ML/NLP and APIs
- Produced supporting infrastructure including technical documentation, website analytics, user support workflows, and volunteer coordination processes for ongoing tracker maintenance

Twitter/X

Capstone Consulting Project, Harvard Kennedy School

Cambridge, MA

Oct 2022 – Apr 2023

- Analyzed Twitter API data and conducted 12 expert interviews to demonstrate prosocial use cases of Twitter in autocratic contexts (small business activity, crisis response, and social activism)

Trustible

AI Governance Consultant

Remote

Jul 2023 – Oct 2023

- Interviewed privacy professionals to author AI white paper on how privacy teams were adapting to AI governance challenges, producing recommendations on organizational readiness, skills gaps, and emerging governance practices

Pensieve: Open-source tool for organizing academic notes using embeddings and LLM-assisted summarization

Selected Writing: 10+ white papers and op-eds in Tech Policy Press, Journalist's Resource, and others; rehanmirza.net

Education

University of Pennsylvania

Ph.D. in Communication, GPA: 4.0 (current)

Philadelphia, PA

Aug 2025 – Present

Advisor: Sandra González-Bailón | Center for Information Networks and Democracy

Harvard Kennedy School

Master in Public Policy

Cambridge, MA

May 2023

University College London

MSc Global Health and Development

London, UK

Sep 2016

University of Cambridge

BA Economics

Cambridge, UK

Jun 2014

Skills

Technical: Python, R, Stata, NLP/ML, LLM-assisted classification, API integration, GitHub, Qualtrics, Tableau

Methods: Experimental design, survey design, statistical modeling, content analysis, causal inference, qualitative interviews

Domains: Platform governance, trust and safety, information integrity, online discourse, AI governance, prosocial design